DEAR MAN worksheet

DBT interpersonal effectiveness
Plan one conversation per sheet

Use DEAR MAN when you need to ask for something or say no. Write your own words for each step, then practice saying them out loud.

THE SITUATION, AND WHO I'M TALKING TO

WHAT I WANT FROM THIS CONVERSATION

WHAT TO SAY

D — Describe

Just the facts of the situation. No judgments, no "always" or "never".

E — Express

How I feel or what I think about it. "I feel...", "I think...".

A — Assert

Ask for exactly what I want, or say no clearly. Don't hint.

R — Reinforce

What's in it for them if they say yes. Say thank you in advance.

HOW TO SAY IT

M — (Stay) Mindful

The one line I'll keep coming back to if we get off track or I'm attacked.

A — Appear confident

How I'll hold myself: voice, eye contact, posture. No apologizing for asking.

N — Negotiate

What I can offer or accept instead. A question to ask them: "What would work for you?"

AFTERWARDS: WHAT HAPPENED, AND WHAT I'D CHANGE NEXT TIME

DATE

DEAR MAN is a skill from Marsha Linehan's Dialectical Behavior Therapy. This worksheet is general education, not medical advice. Free to print and copy for personal or clinical use.

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